



A WINDOW near a makeshift memorial to Alex Pretti in Minneapolis on Monday bears damage from gunfire. ROBERTO SCHMIDT AFP/Getty Images

## BORDER LEADER’S EXIT MAY CHANGE LITTLE

Bovino is set to leave Minneapolis, but Stephen Miller still shapes the policies.

By JENNY JARVIE

For months, Gregory Bovino has been the public face of President Trump’s sweeping immigration raids across U.S. cities.

When the brash Border Patrol commander charged into Los Angeles last summer with the stated mission of arresting thousands of immigrants, he was unapologetic as agents smashed car windows, concealed their identities with masks, seized brown-skinned Angelenos off the streets, and descended on MacArthur Park on horseback.

In Minneapolis, when a federal officer shot and killed U.S. citizen Renee Good on Jan. 7, Bovino’s response to Fox News’ Sean Hannity was, “Hats off to that ICE agent.”

And when a Border Patrol agent shot Alex Pretti, a 37-year-old intensive care unit nurse, on Saturday, Bovino again defended the killing. Pretti, he said, looked like someone who “wanted to do maximum damage and massacre law enforcement.”

But as public outrage has swelled against the Trump administration’s aggressive tactics, Bovino’s future is in limbo. On Monday, Trump deployed border advisor Tom Homan to Minnesota, with Bovino reportedly set to depart the region.

Now, the question remains: Will Bovino’s departure really change the Trump playbook?

Ariel G. Ruiz Soto — a senior policy analyst at the Migration Policy Institute, a Washington, D.C., think tank — said Bovino’s exit, if true, could represent a pivotal moment in immigration enforcement in the nation’s interior.

“I think it signals that the tensions have risen so significantly that there’s beginning to be ruptures and fragments within the Trump administration to try to figure out how to do this enforcement more efficiently, but also with more accountability,” Ruiz Soto said.

Other immigration experts, however, question the significance of sidelining Bovino.

“I think it’s a grave mistake to think the change in the personnel on the ground constitutes a change in policy,” said Lucas Guttentag, a professor of law at Stanford University who specializes in immigration. “Because the policy remains the same: to terrorize immigrant communities and intimidate [See Bovino, A6]

## Federal tactics defy policing guidelines

Experts see disregard for laws and people’s lives

By Kevin Rector

Drawing on decades of experience after having dealt with the beating of Rodney King, the killing of George Floyd and more, American law enforcement leaders, civil rights advocates and other legal experts have honed best practices for officers making street arrests, conducting crowd control and maintaining public safety amid mass protests.

Officers are trained to not stand in front of or reach into moving vehicles, to never pull their firearms unless it is absolutely necessary, and to use force only in proportion to a corresponding threat. They are trained to clearly identify themselves, de-escalate tensions, respect the sanctity of life and quickly render aid to anyone they wound.

When police shootings occur, leaders are trained to carefully protect evidence

and immediately launch an investigation — or multiple ones — in order to assure the community that any potential wrongdoing by officers will be fairly assessed.

According to many of those same leaders and experts, it has become increasingly clear in recent days that those standards have been disregarded — if not entirely tossed aside — by the federal immigration agents swarming into American cities on the orders of President Trump and administration officials tasked with overseeing the operations.

In both small, increasingly routine ways and sudden, stunning bursts — such as the fatal shootings of U.S. citizens Renee Good and Alex Pretti in Minneapolis — agents have badly breached those standards, the experts said, and without any apparent [See Tactics, A6]

## Calls mount for World Cup boycott

By Kevin Baxter

A growing number of international leaders are suggesting it’s time to reconsider the idea of playing the World Cup in the United States this summer.

Oke Gottlich, vice president of the German Football Assn., told a German newspaper last week that he wants to discuss a boycott of the tournament, much like the U.S.-led boycott of the 1980 Moscow Olympics following the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan.

“By my reckoning,” Gottlich said, “the potential threat is greater now than it was then. We need to have this discussion.”

Politicians in Britain and

France had already raised the idea of a World Cup boycott. But now the whispers are growing into a chorus.

Nearly two dozen European football association heads held informal talks in Budapest, Hungary, last week to discuss their participation in the World Cup.

A veteran coach of several African national teams urged a boycott, and a United Nations diplomat and international law expert has canceled his World Cup tickets, fearing for his safety in the U.S. amid violent federal immigration crackdowns in Minnesota and other cities throughout the United States.

“ICE may decide that I am a gang member and I’ll [See Soccer, A7]



NICHOLAS POLLIER Bloomberg  
PROTESTERS hold Greenlandic flags during a demonstration in Copenhagen against President Trump.

## A homecoming in January

Students return to Pali High a year after devastating wildfire

By Christopher Buchanan and Howard Blume



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times  
PARENTS cheer as students arrive Tuesday. About 30% of Pali High was damaged in the Palisades fire.

For the first time in more than a year, the hill on which Palisades Charter High School stands was awash with students Tuesday, an early morning homecoming for a school community still recovering from a year of upheaval after the Palisades fire maelstrom damaged and shut down the popular campus by the sea.

Parents decked out in the blue and white colors of the Pali High Dolphins lined the entrance and cheered on their teenagers. They raised pom-poms and signs that read “Welcome Back!” Their campus has long been the pride of the Palisades, a public school with a strong enrollment that draws students from nearby neighborhoods and a wide swath of Los Angeles.

Many of the students looked a bit groggy amid the 7:30 a.m. hoopla, another change to their routine. Yet they mustered small smiles and waves walking into campus after the long absence, grappling with an array of [See School, A8]

## Meta, YouTube face trial over dangers to kids

TikTok and Snap settle claims ahead of closely watched case getting started in L.A.

By Sonja Sharp

TikTok has agreed to settle the first in a series of closely watched product liability cases, bowing out on the eve of a landmark trial that could upend how social media giants engage their youngest users and leave tech titans on the hook for billions in damages.

The settlement was reached as jury selection was set to begin in Los Angeles County Superior Court on Tuesday and comes a week after Snap reached a deal with the same plaintiff, a Chico, Calif., woman who said she became addicted to social media starting in elementary school.

“This settlement should come as no surprise because that damning evidence is just the tip of the iceberg,” said Sacha Haworth, executive director of the Tech Oversight Project, an industry watchdog. “This was only the first case — there are hundreds of parents and school districts in the social media addiction trials that start today, and sadly, new families every day who are speaking out and bringing Big Tech to court for its deliberately harmful products.”

TikTok did not immediately respond to requests for comment about Monday’s settlement.

“The Parties are pleased to have been able to resolve this matter in an amicable manner,” Snap spokeswoman Monique Bellamy said of the settlement.

The remaining defendants, Instagram parent company Meta and Google’s YouTube, still face claims that their products are “defective” and designed to keep children hooked to apps its makers know are harmful.

Those same arguments are at the heart of at least 2,500 cases currently pending together in state and federal courts. The Los Angeles trial is among a handful of bellwethers meant to clarify the uncharted legal terrain.

Social media companies are protected by the 1st Amendment and by Section 230, a decades-old law that shields internet companies from liability for what users produce and share on their platforms.

Attorneys for the Chico plaintiff, referred to in court documents as K.G.M., say the apps were built and refined to snare youngsters and keep them on the platforms without regard for dangers the companies knew lurked there, including sexual predation, bullying and promotion of self-harm and even suicide.

As the claims against Meta and YouTube head to trial, jurors will be asked to weigh whether those dangers are incidental or inherent, and if social media companies can be held responsible for the harm families say flowed from their children’s feeds.

Scores of potential jurors filled the beige terrazzo hallway outside Judge Carolyn B. Kuhl’s courtroom downtown Tuesday morning, most passing the time on social apps on their phones. Some watched short-form videos while others thumbed through their feeds, pausing every so often [See Apps, A7]

## Population growth in California flatlines

Lower U.S. immigration levels have come amid Trump’s crackdown.

By Terry Castleman and Hannah Fry

California’s population stalled in 2024 and growth across the country slowed amid widespread immigration raids in the first year of the new Trump administration, U.S. Census Bureau data show.

After years of slow growth in the post-pandemic era, California’s population stayed essentially flat from July 2024 to July 2025, according to Census Bureau data released Tuesday. At the same time, the data show that the United States’ population grew by only half a percent, or roughly 1.8 million people, a much lower rate than the previous year when it increased by 3.2 million people.

Experts attribute the stagnation largely to lower levels of migration to the United States from other countries as the Trump administration has sought to curtail immigration and embarked on deportation efforts in Los Angeles and other major cities. The foreign-born population in the U.S. dropped by 1.5 million people, or 2.6%, from January to July last year, data show.

In California, changing immigration policies, along with people leaving the Golden State for other places, an aging population and declining birth rates all contribute to the population slump. Continued drops in immigration could have [See Population, A8]

### School kept in dark on gunman

Fullerton residents question the police role amid an ICE raid near Woodcrest Elementary. CALIFORNIA, B1

### Anatomy of her perfect 10

UCLA’s Jordan Chiles and her choreographer explain what goes into the floor exercise routine. SPORTS, B10

### The nostalgic pull of Sundance

With the festival in its last days at Park City, Utah, film critic Amy Nicholson reminisces. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

### Weather

Periods of sunshine. L.A. Basin: 73/52. B6

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